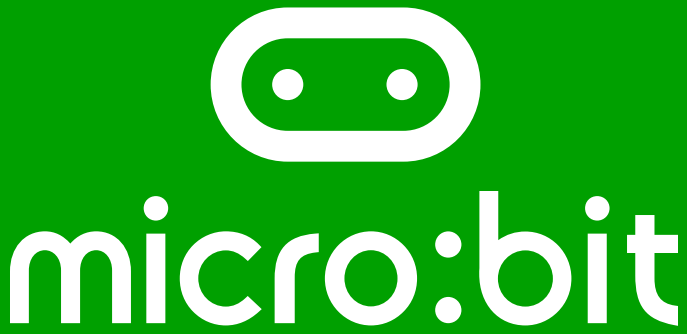


Brand Guidelines

November 2023

Micro:bit Educational Foundation

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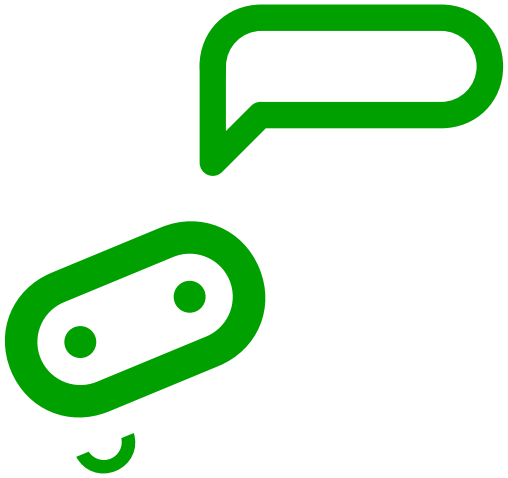
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1.0 Introduction



Let's get started



Welcome to the Micro:bit Educational Foundation and BBC micro:bit brand guidelines.

These guidelines are designed to ensure that the micro:bit identity is applied consistently around the world, so that children and teachers build a strong relationship with technology and learning. In following these guidelines you're helping to inspire a new generation of innovators, coders and creators.

If you would like to use our brand, you can only do so in these circumstances:

- in connection with the sale or distribution of genuine micro:bit products or services.
- an educator or a child referring to or describing the micro:bit for a non-commercial purpose.
- if you've got specific permission from us to use our brand.

When using our brand you must credit 'Micro:bit Educational Foundation' and/or link to our website (microbit.org or the direct webpage).

For more information on usage permissions, go to microbit.org/brand-guidelines or get in touch with us to confirm.

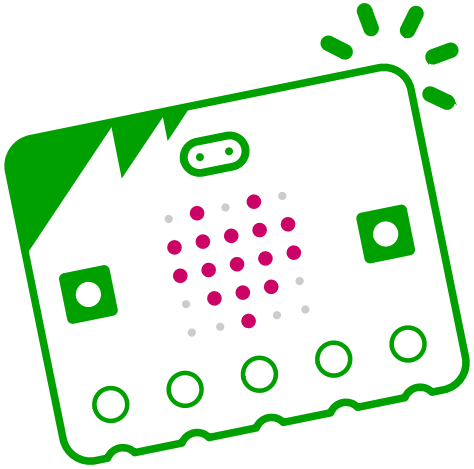
We aim to keep these guidelines up to date so keep checking back to ensure you're working from the most current guidance. For approvals, or if you have any questions, please do get in touch.

What is the BBC micro:bit?

The BBC micro:bit is a pocket-sized computer that introduces you to how software and hardware work together. It has an LED light display, buttons, sensors and many input/output features (including sound sensing and playback capabilities) that you can program and physically interact with.

Through the micro:bit, children are encouraged to explore their ideas while using real code and real computational thinking, helping to inspire critical thinking and creativity. As a tool, it provides authentic experiences of the interaction between software and hardware, growing children's computing knowledge and putting a practical purpose into their studies.

Find out more at
https://microbit.org/get-started/what-is-the-microbit/



What is the Micro:bit Educational Foundation?



The Micro:bit Educational Foundation is a not-for-profit organisation that aims to inspire every child to create their best digital future.

We do this by:

- developing hardware and software that inspires young people to get excited about technology and the opportunities it presents for them
- creating free, user-friendly educational resources to support teachers in delivering engaging and creative lessons
- working with like-minded partners to deliver high-impact educational programmes across the globe.

Find out more at https://microbit.org/about/

2.0 Brand language



Referencing the BBC micro:bit

It's vitally important to be consistent when referring to the BBC micro:bit and the Micro:bit Educational Foundation.

When writing 'micro:bit' you should always use a colon in between 'micro' and 'bit,' including when we refer to 'the Micro:bit Educational Foundation.'

When writing about the Foundation - the Micro:bit Educational Foundation - a capital 'M' should be used

When writing informally about the 'Foundation' always use a capital 'F'.

When writing about the device - the BBC micro:bit and the micro:bit - a lowercase 'm' should be used.

When writing about the device, always introduce the first use of the name as 'the BBC micro:bit' and within the same context after that use the name, 'the micro:bit'.

It is possible to refer to, 'your BBC micro:bit' and 'your micro:bit' - applying the same rule that the first use of the device name introduces, 'BBC'.



Correct usage

the **BBC micro:bit**

the **micro:bit**

the **Micro:bit Educational Foundation**

powered by the **BBC micro:bit**

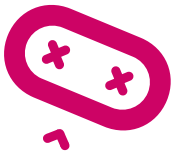
the **BBC micro:bit** at [name of event]

the **Micro:bit Educational Foundation** at [name of event]

[name of partner] is a **BBC micro:bit** champion

[name of partner activity] is part of the **Micro:bit Educational Foundation**

[name of partner] is a **Micro:bit Educational Foundation** partner



Incorrect usage

micro:bit (always 'the micro:bit')

MICRO:Bit

micro:BIT

microbit

micro-bit

Micro:Bit

Micro:bit

m:b

mb

MEF

The micro:bit Educational Foundation

The Micro:BIT Educational Foundation

The MICROBIT Educational Foundation

Brand line

The brand line encapsulates what the micro:bit stands for. It's an anchor point to build messaging around.

It can be used as a headline or as a sign off within body copy.

Our tone of voice should be straightforward, inclusive and optimistic.

For more detailed tone of voice guidance, contact us.

1. This is an example of how the brand line can be used as a stacked headline.

Create
Learn
Code

2. This is how the brand line can be used as a inline heading.

Create | Learn | Code

3.0 Brand identity & logo mark



Primary Logo Mark (stacked)

This is the main Logo Mark and should be used in most instances.

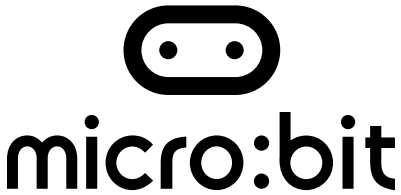
1. Colour Logo

The primary colour is the green and is the preferred logo and colour to be used throughout communications.



2. Black Logo

To be used when there are no colour options available, for example 1-tone printed work.



3. White Logo on colour

The logo can feature on any of the main colours and black from the palette as white out only.

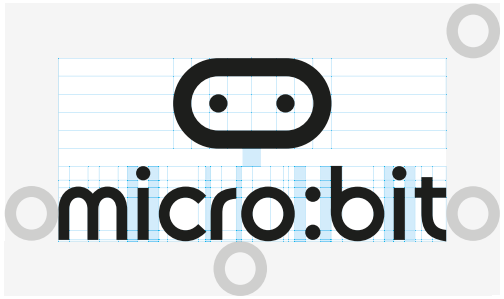


When using this logo ensure sufficient contrast through the background image or patterns.



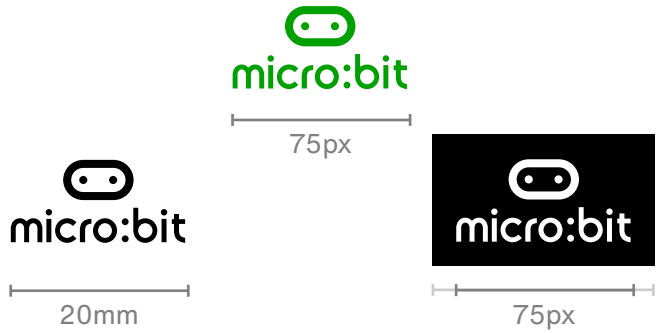
4. Logo Exclusion Area

This exclusion area is defined by the size of a single ‘O’ as shown here.



5. Minimum Size

Minimum logo size 20mm for printed materials and 75px for any on line use.



Secondary Logo Mark (flat)

To be used when the design does not allow for the Primary Logo Mark to be used.

1. Colour Logo

The primary colour is the green and is the preferred logo and colour to be used throughout communications.

3. White Logo on colour

The logo can feature on any of the main colours and black from the palette as white out only.

4. Logo Exclusion Area

This exclusion area is defined by the size of a single ‘O’ as shown here.

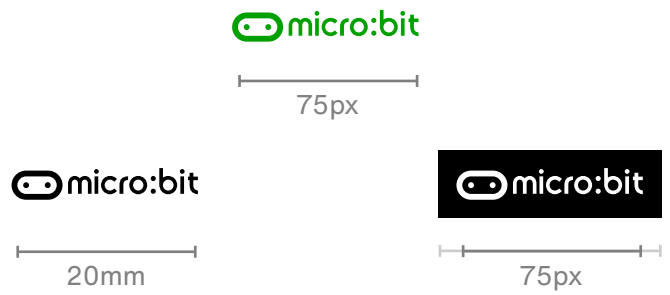
2. Black Logo

To be used when there are no colour options available, for example 1-tone printed work.

When using this logo ensure sufficient contrast through the background image or patterns.

5. Minimum Size

Minimum logo size 20mm for printed materials and 75px for any on line use.



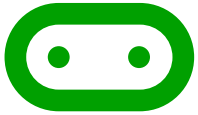
Tertiary Logo Mark (Glyph)

The logo glyph should only be used when space is at a premium and the primary and secondary marks can't be used, or the word mark will be unreadable in the design e.g. as a favicon.

It should not be used in a way where it is not a logo for micro:bit eg in an illustration or decorative picture. The emoji bank can be used in those instances.

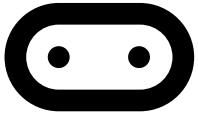
1. Colour Logo

The primary colour is the green and is the option to be used throughout communications.



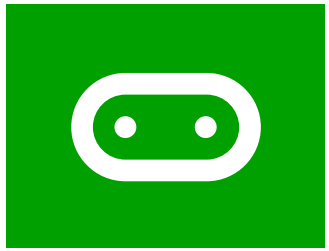
2. Black Logo

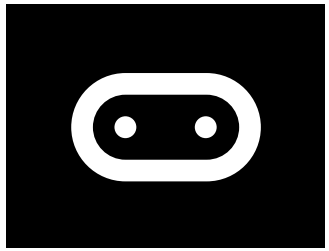
To be used when there are no colour options available, for example 1-tone printed work.



3. White Logo on colour

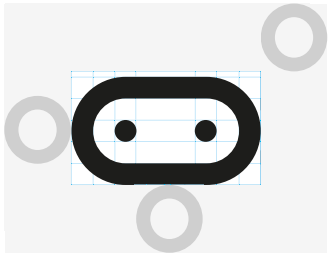
The glyph logo can feature on any of the main colours and black from the palette as white out only.





4. Logo Exclusion Area

This exclusion area is defined by the size of a single 'O' as shown here.



Logo Mark Don’ts

Only use supplied logos and do not edit the logo in anyway.



1. Don’t warp or stretch the logo.



2. Don’t change the logo’s orientation.



3. Don’t rearrange the symbol or wordmark configurations within the logo.



4. Don’t change the logo’s colours.



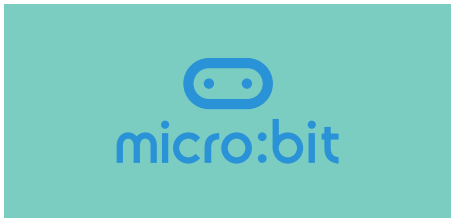
5. Don’t crop the logo in any way or remove the glyph.



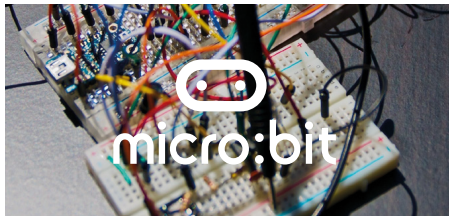
6. Don’t apply shadows, glow effects, or outlines to the logo.



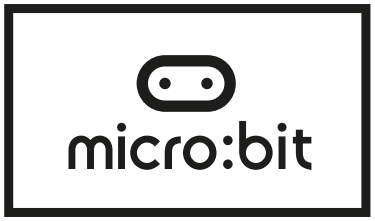
7. Don’t apply any filters or textures to the logo.



8. Don’t use the logo on colours with poor contrast or similar colours.

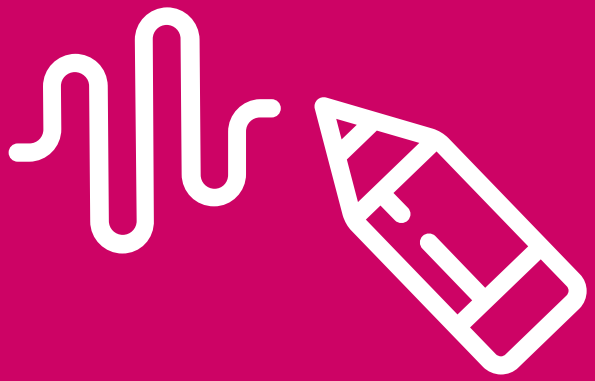


9. Don’t use the logo on busy photographs or patterns with low contrast.



10. Don’t contain the logo within a box on a page.

4.0 Typography



Our Typefaces

We use two typefaces across the micro:bit brand, for a consistent appearance on an offline.

GT Walsheim is our lead brand typeface. It is used on and offline for headlines, titles, subtitles and large pull-out text. It is not used for body copy.

Helvetica Now is our secondary font and is used for body copy across all communications. It should never be more prominent than GT Walsheim.

On occasions when the brand fonts cannot be used and there is no other option but to default to a system font, Arial should be used.

GT Walsheim is our lead brand typeface

It is available in two weights, Bold and Regular, used across the micro:bit product for headlines, titles, subtitles and large pull-out text. It is not used for body copy.



GT Walsheim Bold
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
ABCDEFGHIJKLM
NOPQRSTUVWXYZ
1234567890



GT Walsheim Regular
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
ABCDEFGHIJKLM
NOPQRSTUVWXYZ
1234567890

Helvetica Now is our secondary brand typeface

Available in two weights – Bold and Regular. It should be used on and off line for body copy and small elements of text.



Helvetica Now Bold
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
ABCDEFGHIJKLM
NOPQRSTUVWXYZ
1234567890



Helvetica Now Regular
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
ABCDEFGHIJKLM
NOPQRSTUVWXYZ
1234567890

Type Treatment

Hierarchy and emphasis are important tools in creating structure and consitency throughout our content.

By using variations in the size or font weight of headings, subheadings, and important elements, we can direct the reader's attention and emphasize key information. This helps users quickly scan and understand the content's structure and importance.

Using a common ratio to define the sizes and proportaions of our different content elements helps create a harmonious design. The example treatment opposite employs the Classical Scale 9, 10, 11, 12, 14, 16, 18, 21, 24, 36, 48, 60, 72, and so forth.

The mimimum font size for print is 12pt and though digital media allows users to adjust font sizes and zoom, we should always aim to maximise accessibility for the default view.

We will discuss colour and contrast of text in the next chapter.

Heading One ..... GT Walsheim Bold

Heading Two ..... GT Walsheim Bold

Heading Three ..... Helvetica Now Bold

Body copy - Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit, sed do eiusmod tempor incididunt ut labore et dolore magna aliqua. Ut enim ad minim veniam, quis nostrud exercitation ullamco laboris nisi ut aliquip ex ea commodo consequat. ..... Helvetica Now Regular

Highlights within the body copy ..... Helvetica Now Bold

5.0 Colour Palette & Usage

The Colour Palette

The micro:bit brand uses colour to promote a vibrant personality and an inquistiveness to lead our users on an exciting journey.

Only colours from our palette should be used on micro:bit communications.

The palette is grouped into 3 pairs of complimentary colours (Green/Blue, Red/Orange and Purple/Teal). Limiting use of colour to one pair per page helps set a balanced tone to a design.

These colours must be used in the correct formats and not to be mixed up (CMYK for print, RGB for digital).

Where necessary the colours can be altered to make them lighter or darker, by adding either white or black at increments of either 10%, 20%, 30%, 50% and 80%.

To support the main primary colours we can use grey tones for both print and digital. Each grey is a tint of 100% black to white.

Green

RGB 0/160/0
Hex #00a000
CMYK 80/10/100/0
Pantone 2423

Blue

RGB 42/146/214
Hex #2a94d6
CMYK 85/0/6/0
Pantone 298

Red

RGB 205/3/101
Hex #CD0365
CMYK 25/91/25/9
Pantone Rubine Red

Orange

RGB 231/100/92
Hex #E7645C
CMYK 5/72/56/0
Pantone 178

Purple

RGB 108/75/193
Hex #6C4BC1
CMYK 69/76/0/0
Pantone 2089

Teal

RGB 123/205/194
Hex #7BCDC2
CMYK 59/2/36/0
Pantone 565

0% 10% 20% 30% 50% 80% 100%

Colour Accessibility

We have a responsibility to ensure all our products and communications are accessible to all.

Not everyone will have the same visual capabilities. Some may have difficulty distinguishing certain colours, particularly those with a colour vision deficiency. It is important to design with sufficient colour contrast so that people with visual impairments are still able to read the content clearly without additional strain.

As talked about in the typography chapter, size and contrast of text is important in hitting our goal of maximising readability and legibility.

Black or dark grey (80% black) paired with white has a high contrast ratio and is fine to use for any size text. However our brand colours can only be used in certain cases for text.

Here we outline the minimum sizing and contrast rules to meet the accessibility guidelines as set by both APCA and WCAG.

Large Text

To comply with both APCA and WCAG AA, only green blue, red, purple, black and dark grey for large text of 18pt (24px) or larger. This can either be colour text on a white background or white on a colour background.

Correct



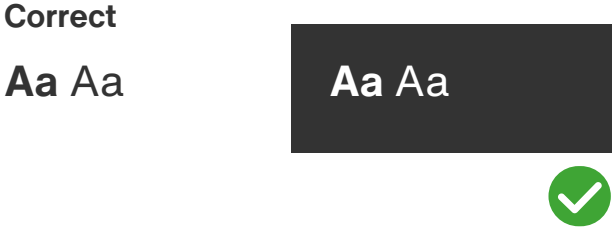
Incorrect



Small Text

Ideally all text of 14pt (18.5px) or smaller should use either only black or dark grey (minumum 80% tint), no colour text should be used at small scale. Red and Purple will still pass, though should be avoided if possible.

Correct



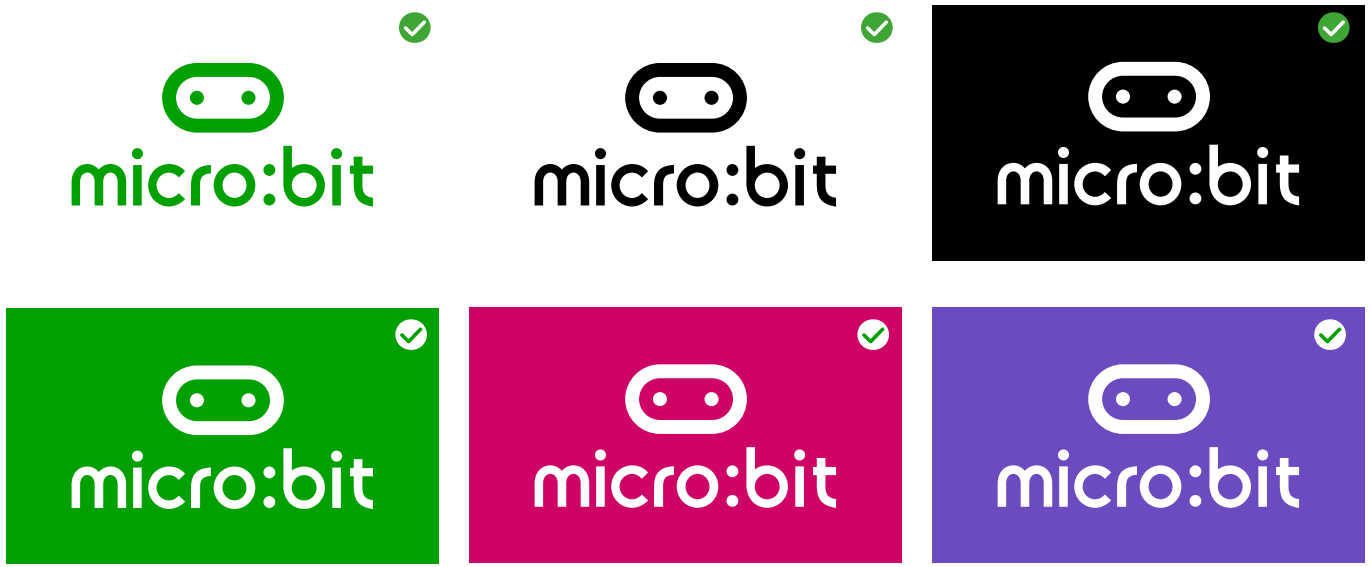
Incorrect



Logo Colour Do's and Don'ts

The green from the colour palette should always be used when producing the logo in full colour on white backgrounds. If used on a colour or white/black background the white logo must be used.

The black/or white logo can be used when colour reproduction is not viable.



1. Don't use other than green, black or white.

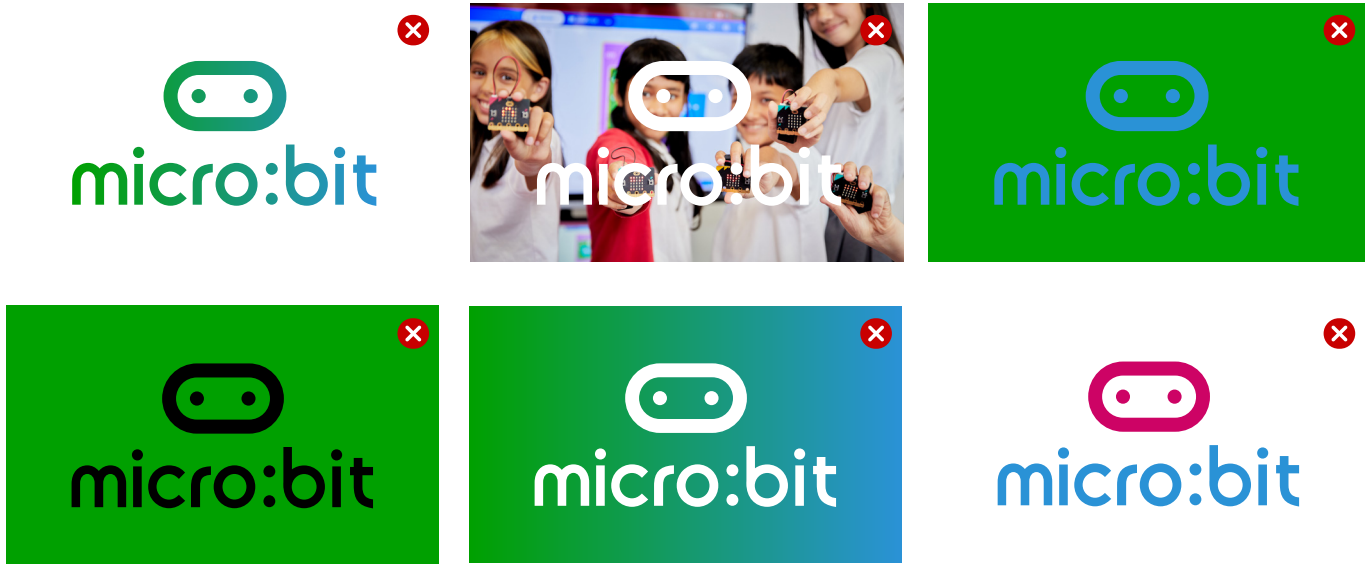
2. Do not place logo over a busy background such as photography.

3. Do not place the logo on a background where is cannot be seen clearly.

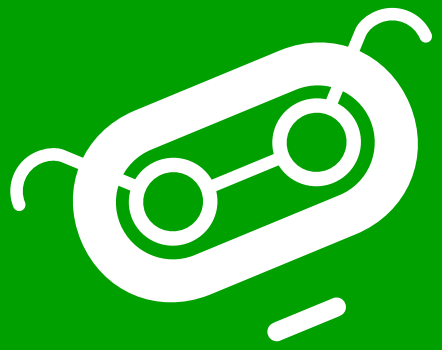
4. Do not use the black logo on green or vice versa.

5. Do not use the logo on a gradient background.

6. Do not mix the colours of the logo.



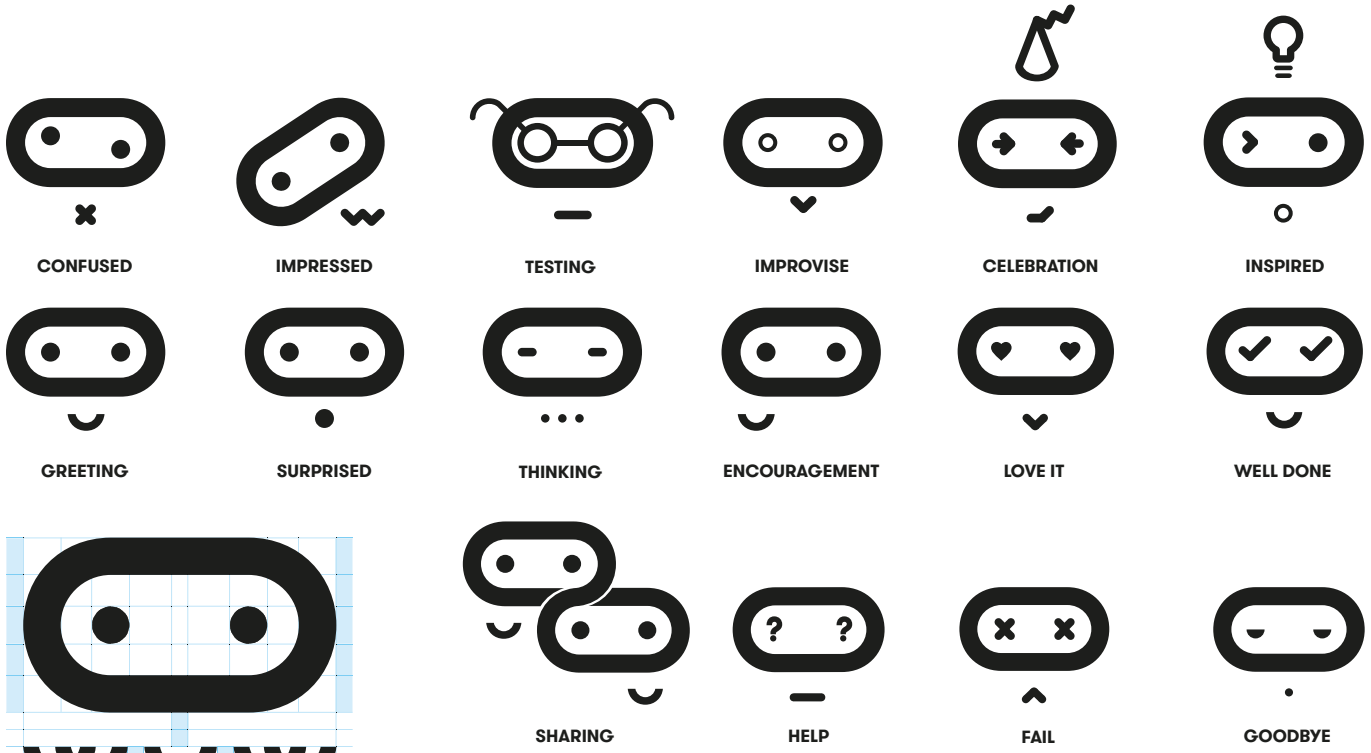
6.0 Visual Characteristics



Emojis

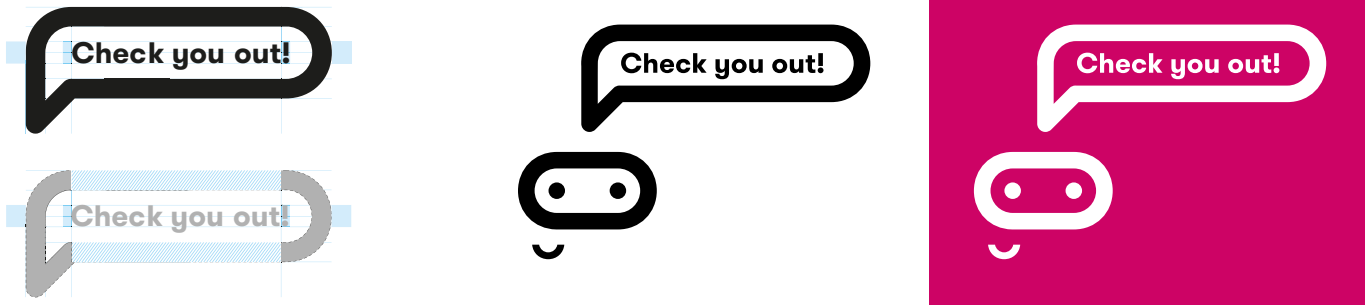
The micro:bit emojis allow us to express our brand personality. They can be teaching, learning, confused and cheeky. But never bored.

Certain emojis are more obvious in nature than others. Therefore some need to be used in conjunction with the “emoji” language and speech bubble device.



Our audience are masters of smart back chat, so we can be too, or at least the micro:bit can. The micro:bit can be surprising, astonishing and adventurous. It can do anything.

So a little robot speak is the perfect antidote to the calm voice of instruction. The speech bubble device allows us to do this in a simple yet creative way.



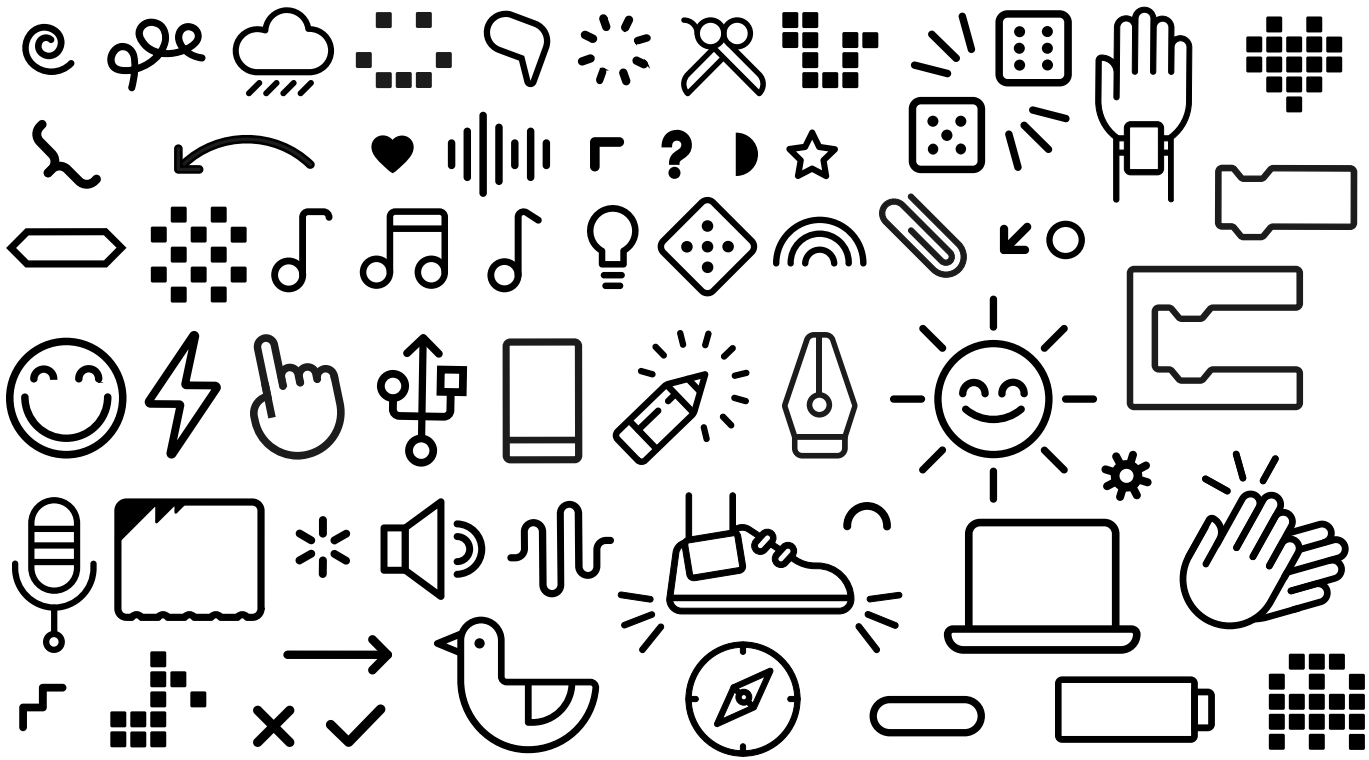
Icons

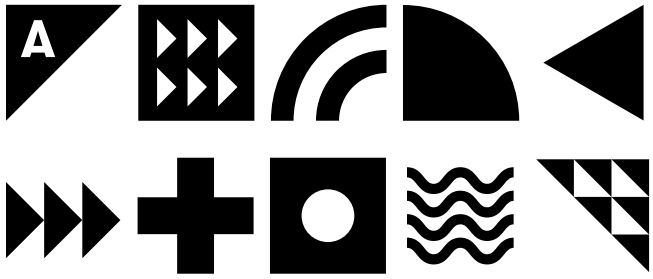
Icons help us convey specific themes related to the technology or capabilities of the micro:bit.

The micro:bit icon library can be used alongside other brand elements to enhance the story and envoke the thrill of exploring learning with the micro:bit. Whether by expressing an interaction, movement or a revelation, icons help bring the brand to life.

The icons can be used in a variety of different ways:

- as a subtle patterned background. Use a low contrast colour combination to allow any content to remain the focus.
- as interchangeable decals to supplement largely text content. Use sparingly: 2-5 icons per page, and limit to just two coordinating colours (green/blue, red/orange or purple/teal).
- to provide visual context to diagrams and process flows. Again limit colours so that they support rather than clash with the content.





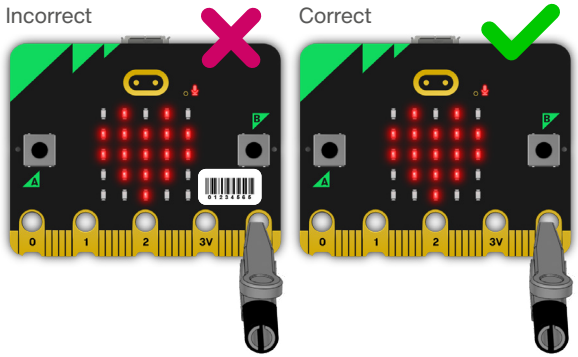
The more abstract ‘block icons’ can be used within non-design tools such as slide-decks and text documents to bring break up the content and add some visual interest to the screen or page.

These blocks can use any combination from the colour palette, though it is best not to have two blocks of the same colour sat directly next to one another.

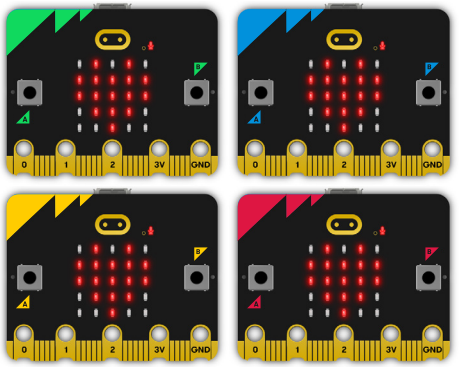
Depicting the micro:bit

When creating an image of the micro:bit product, the mini computer, accuracy is incredibly important, particularly when it comes to instructions on how to use the micro:bit. When displaying the micro:bit being connected, show the easiest and most reliable way to connect the crocodile clips. This should be 90 degrees to the plane of the board.

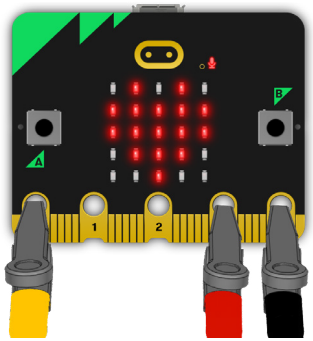
You can use our vector graphics of the micro:bit at github.com/microbit-foundation/microbit-svg as a base.



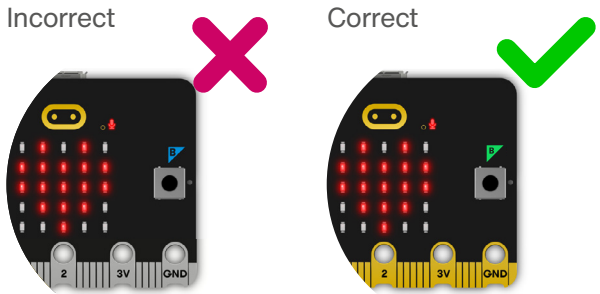
1. Don’t show the serial number.



2. Only show the micro:bit in its available colours (green, blue, yellow, red).



3. When displaying the micro:bit being connected show the clips on your diagram and explain the best way to connect them.

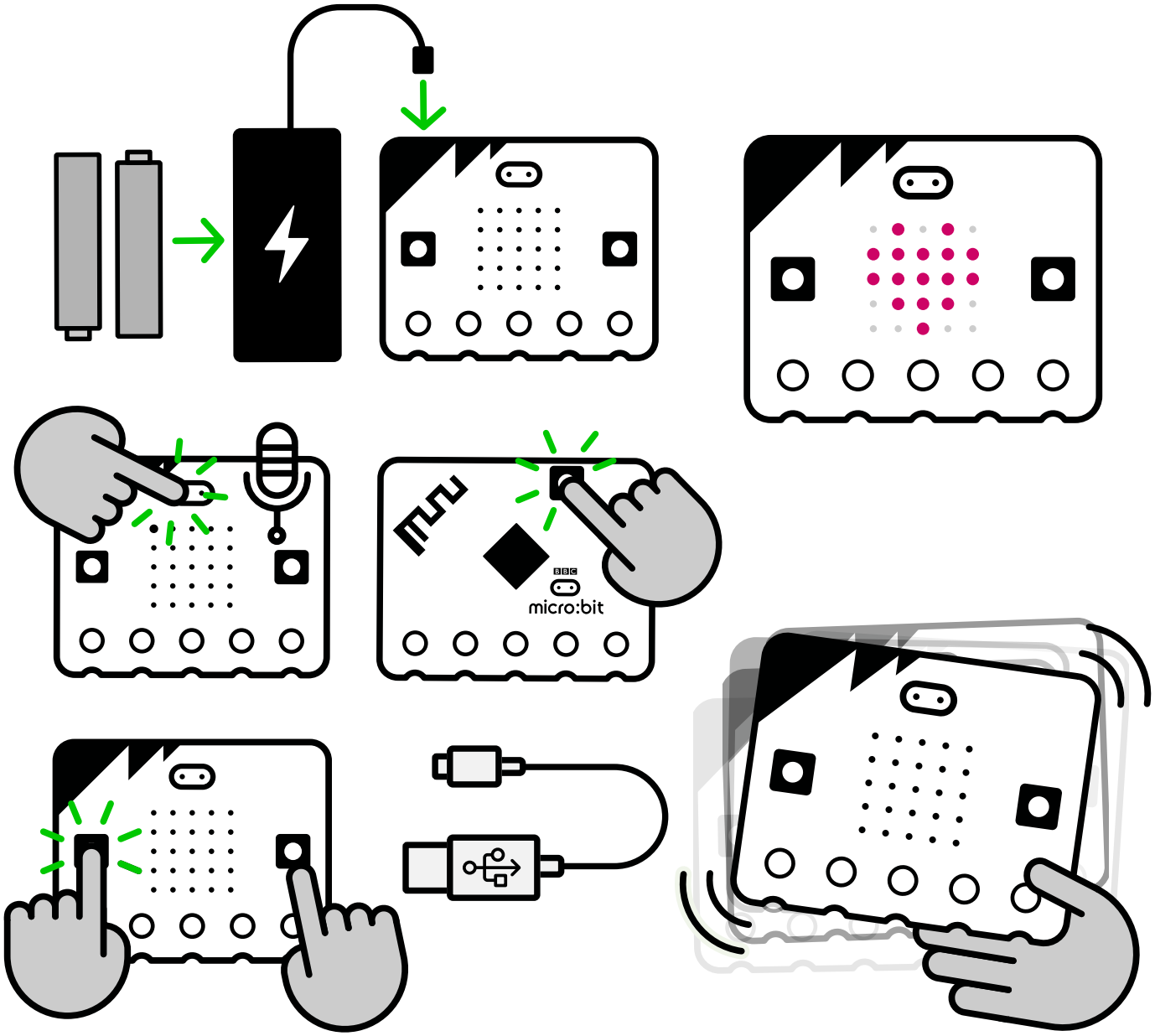


4. Make sure the edge connector is shown with a gold colour.

Line Diagrams

When we are wanting to give clear instructions on how to physically interact with the micro:bit, we use diagramatic line-art.

This style simplifies the recognisable form and features of the micro:bit, to that any distractors are removed.



Photography

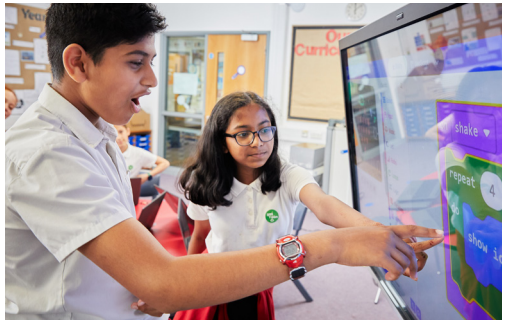
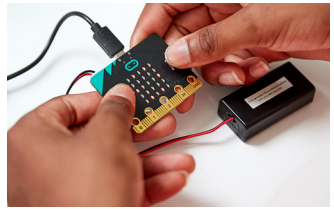
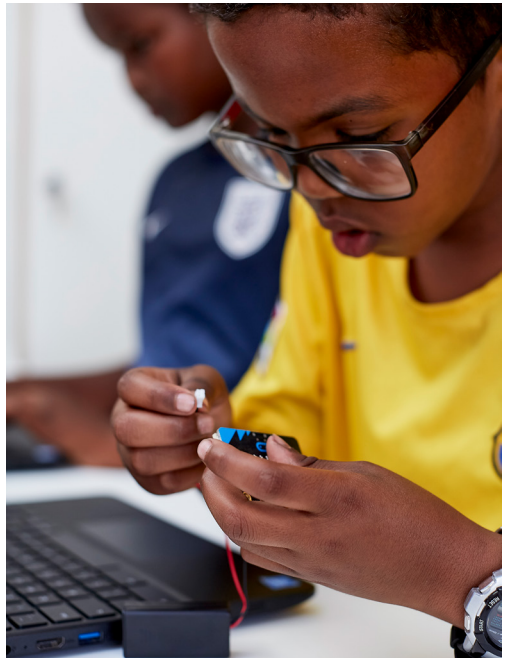
Our photography is centered around inspiring digital creativity.

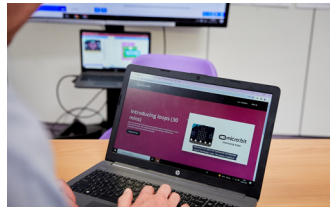
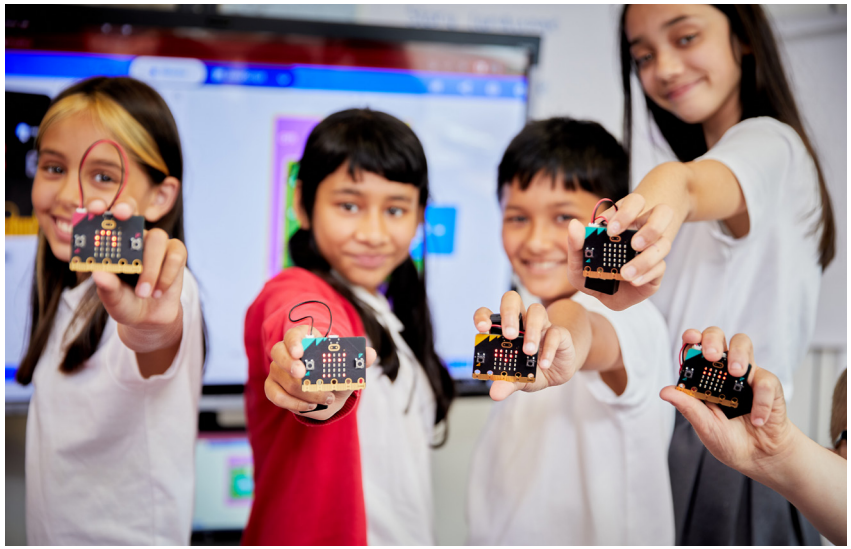
It should show children and/or teachers engaging with the micro:bit.

When possible we always try to use bespoke photography however when this isn't possible stock photography can be used. Any stock photography should feel authentic and natural.

To reflect the fact that we aim to reach everyone, photography should portray people from all backgrounds, cultures, ethnicities and with diverse characteristics.

Images on page: Micro:bit Educational Foundation use only


7.0 Using our Brand with Partners



Co-branding Do's and Don'ts

The micro:bit logo and partner logos should appear on marketing and communications together – reflecting the joint nature of the partnership.

Side by side
micro:bit and third party logos shown side-by-side should be all of equal importance and listed alphabetically.



Clearly distinct logos
These should be clearly separated as two distinct logos. They should be at least two 'o' width apart unless space is very limited e.g. on line.



Size and prominence
Foundation-led marketing activity should put the micro:bit logo first and be ⅔rds larger. Partner-led marketing activity should put the partner logo first and be ⅔rds larger.



The micro:bit logo and partner logos should never appear in any of the following ways:

One colour, one greyscale.
Always use the colour micro:bit logo. Never change the logo colour to suit the other partners colourways.



Hybrid logos and lockups
Never create a logo lock up with micro:bit.



Insufficient spacing
Always ensure there is enough space between the two logos; keeping them distinct from one another.





8.0 Differentiating micro:bit versions

The micro:bit V1 and V2

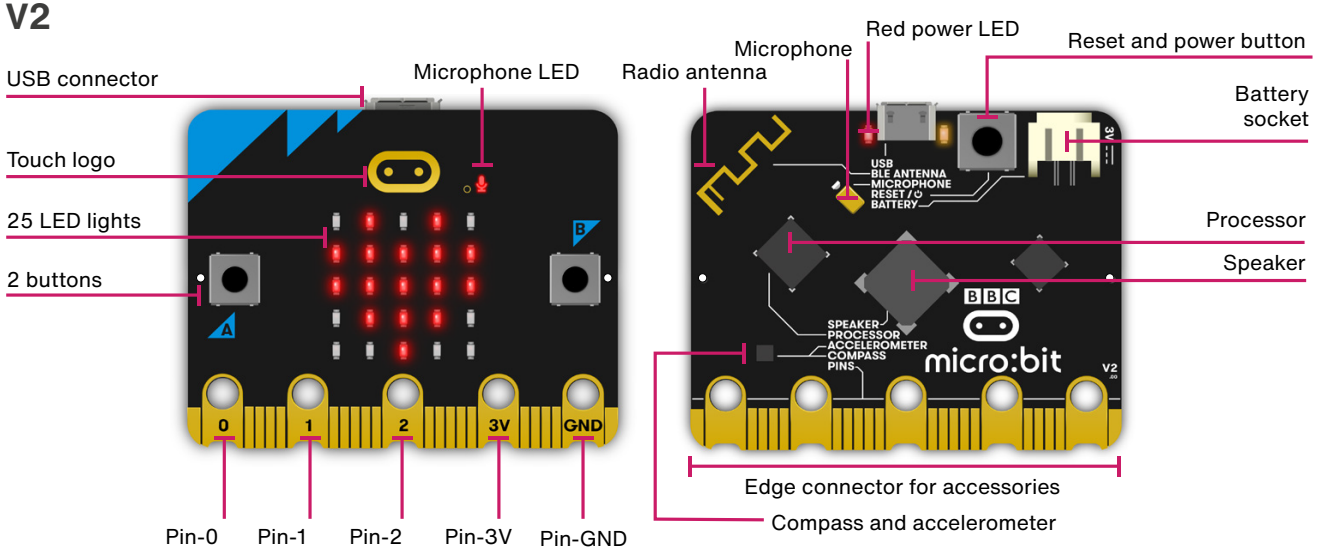
There are two versions of the micro:bit (V1) and (V2).

The differences between the two versions can be seen when comparing these graphics and the components on the device.

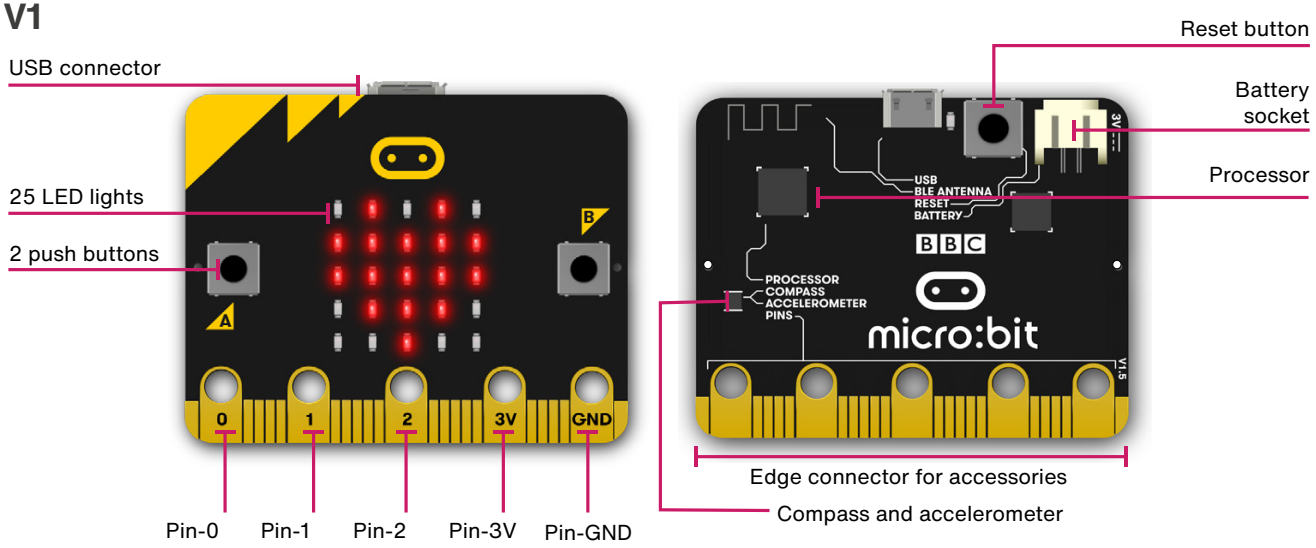
The current and previous iterations of the micro:bit have subtle differences which you can view on the graphics adjacent.

The micro:bit V2 is the most recent iteration of the micro:bit device and it includes a built-in speaker, microphone and touch sensor.

V2



V1



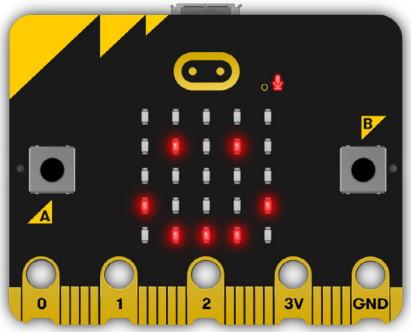
Which micro:bit version?

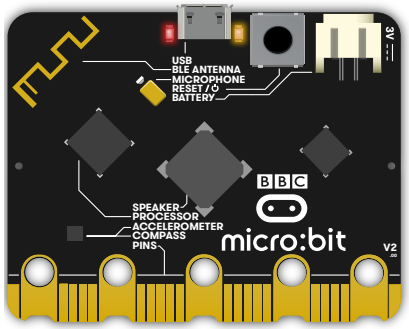
It is important to make clear which micro:bit is being used or sold.

When displaying a specific micro:bit product (board only) on websites, catalogues etc. use the correct version logo to denote which micro:bit version it is.

V2

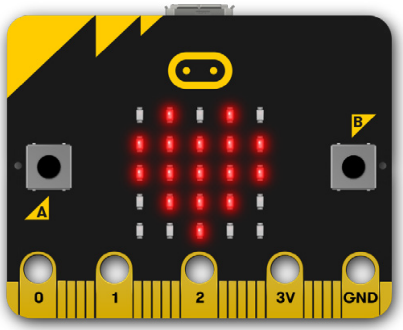
Use this mark only when referring to the micro:bit V2 itself, i.e. the board.

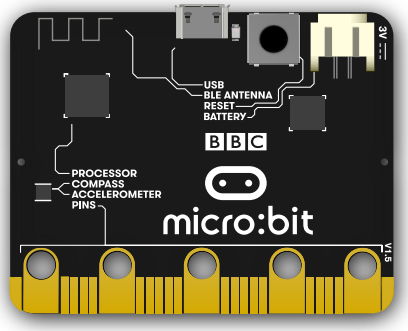




V1

Use this mark only when referring to the micro:bit V1 itself, i.e. the board.





Compatibility

Some accessories or kits may only be compatible with one version of the micro:bit, while others may work with both.

Use the correct logo to communicate compatibility

If your product is compatible with only one version of the micro:bit, please use the correct logo referring to this version. Add this logo to your product page, next to photos of the accessory or kit that it works with.



Use this mark if an accessory only works with a V1 micro:bit

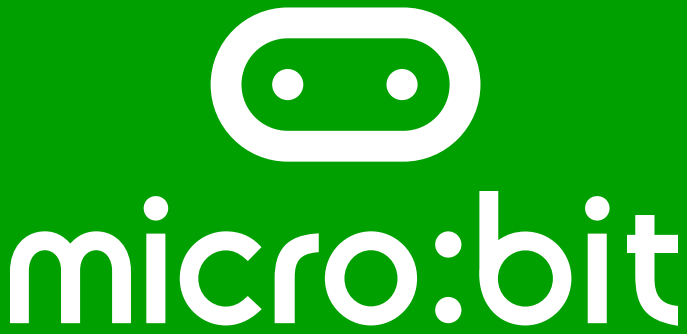


Use this mark if an accessory only works with a V2 micro:bit



If an accessory does not require a specific version, you can use the logo opposite to denote both versions are compatible.

Important: This is not an endorsement of your product or kit by the Foundation and must not be used in a way that implies this. It is not designed to symbolise an official micro:bit product, only to aid differentiation. These visuals must not be used with undue prominence.



For more information, guidance and approvals, please contact info@microbit.org

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